

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4
 ♥ Q 6 5
 ♦ K J 6 2
 ♣ J 6 5 4

♠ J 8 3

♥ A J 9 2

♦ 10 7

♣ 9 8 3 2



♠ Q 6 2

♥ 8 7 4

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ A Q 10

♠ A K 9 7 5

♥ K 10 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ K 7

*West**North**East**South*

2♦

2♠

1♦

1♠

All Pass

2♠ by South

Lead: ♠10

The bidding has been as shown.

With only 7 points you might not think you have enough to make a "free bid". But in competitive bidding situations like these, where both sides have a fit, bidding is usually better than passing. So you bid 2♠.

You might look at the Law of Total Tricks lesson for more on this subject.

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ K J 9 2
♣ A J 6

♠ K 8 4 2

♥ A 9 3

♦ 10 5

♣ K Q 9 3



♠ A 7

♥ J 8 5

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 10 7 5 4

♠ Q J 10 9 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Lead: ♥6

The bidding has been as shown.

You have enough for a 1-level Overcall so you bid 1♠. Partner says 3♠.

The jump raise tells you partner has 11-14 points.

With your minimum it's going to have to be better than that to get you excited. So you pass.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 2
 ♥ J 10 6 4
 ♦ K Q 10 7 4
 ♣ 10 6

♠ K 8 7 5 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A

♣ 7 5 4 3



♠ 10
 ♥ A K Q 9 8
 ♦ J 5 3
 ♣ A K Q 9

♠ A Q J 6 4

♥ 3

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ J 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

4♠

1♥

1♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Lead: ♥J

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 10 points, but in cases like this points don't matter that much. They **MIGHT** be able to make 4♥. Partner **MIGHT** be able to make 4♠. This preemptive jump takes the decision away from them.

Looking at the hands you can see that partner is going to go down 1 at 4♠. However, that is an excellent result since they appear to be cold for 5♥.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 2
♥ J 6 2
♦ J 8 7 2
♣ Q 8 3

♠ A J 7 6

♥ Q 9 7 3

♦ A 5 4

♣ 9 2



♠ K Q 10 4

♥ 5

♦ Q 10 9

♣ K J 10 7 6

♠ 5 3

♥ A K 10 8 4

♦ K 6 3

♣ A 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♣ 3

The bidding has been as shown.

Nice hand. But not nice enough to double, then bid your ♥s. So you overcall 1 ♥. Partner says 3 ♥.

The jump raise promises 11-14 points. Your 17 plus partner's 11 or so takes you right up to game. You bid 4 ♥.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 8 6 3
♥ A 7 6 4
♦ K Q
♣ 10 6

♠ 7 2

♥ Q 8

♦ J 5 2

♣ A K J 9 7 2

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♠ J 10 4

♥ J 9 3

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 8 5 4

♠ A K 5

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ 10 9 7 4

♣ Q 3

West

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♦ K

North

2 ♣

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has at least 11 points for his 2-level overcall. He might have as many as 16. You have a perfect invitational hand including two sure stoppers in their suit. So you bid 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you get to play it there.